Journalist briefing sheet

What this is

An independent, student-run site tracking Sun Prairie's plate reader program with sources. Not affiliated with the City or SPPD. I have met Chief Kevin Warych several times and stay independent. Funding: none (Advocacy Records appendix, p. 330).

Key facts (as of Nov 10, 2026)

- The city has **9** plate reader cameras: 6 city-owned and 3 donated by Woodman's.
- Policy F-18 says plate data is kept **30 days** unless needed for an investigation.
- Every search is supposed to be logged with a case number, a search type and a reason (Policy F-18).
- Axon's estimate is **$235,388.97** over 10 years (May 1, 2027 to Apr 30, 2037). It is a **non-binding draft** that expires Nov 30, 2026.
- The Chief said Axon retention would start as a **14-day, three-month trial** (pending approval).
- The Chief said there would be **no livestreaming** with Axon (pending contract and policy).
- The council's final 2027 budget vote is scheduled for **Nov 17**.
- Flock ends Dec 31 (6 cameras) and Mar 31 (3 cameras). Axon would start May 1, 2027.
- Anyone can ask for public records. Police records go through the city's online portal.

Pending promises (statements, not contract terms)

- No livestreaming (Oct 27)
- 14-day, three-month Axon retention trial, then 14 or 21 days (Oct 27)
- Monthly audits by a Detective Sergeant (Oct 27)
- Post Policy F-18 if approved (Oct 27)
- Public data-sharing MOU after signing (Oct 27)
- Consider a quarterly transparency report (Nov 9)

Open questions

- Are Flock audit logs kept after the cameras come out? (asked Oct 27)
- Will six terms be written into the contract or policy before the vote? (asked Nov 6)
- Records request PD-2399-2026 (filed Nov 9)

Interviews: I am a student; contact first by email. sunprairiealpr@gmail.com. Source: Advocacy Records 2026, Complete Edition v3.0 (Nov 10, 2026): Policy F-18 (p. 213-216), Axon quote Q-932192-001 (p. 247-248), SPPD FAQ (p. 249-256), Tracking (p. 314-319).